Katja Kulmala

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GAME DEVELOPMENT

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

I am a creative and motivated student specializing in both game and software development, passionate about designing and brainstorming, and especially enjoy bringing ideas to life while continuously developing my skills and learning new things. I thrive on creative projects with an awesome team, combining problem-solving, technical skills, and imaginative thinking. My ideal role is in game development, focusing on game mechanics or level design, and I am also interested in gamification and serious games.

EDUCATION

Karelia University of Applied Sciences – Bachelor of Business IT
2023 – present
Program: Information Technology
Specialization: Software Development, Game Development
During my studies, I have strengthened my teamwork skills, gained extensive experience in project management, and developed problem-solving and time management abilities. I have worked extensively with Scrum methodology and Azure DevOps. In game development, I have gained hands-on experience with Unreal Engine and Unity, using Blueprints, C++ and C#. I also have experience with WPF applications using C# and XAML, as well as web development with JavaScript, HTML, and CSS. Database integration has been part of several projects, using MySQL, MariaDB, and HeidiSQL. Version control has been managed through GitHub and Azure DevOps.

Turku Vocational Institute – Catering Services Supervisor / Industrial Chef *2005 – 2008*

WORK EXPERIENCE

Game Development / Level Design Intern – MiTale
Internship: January–April 2026 | Thesis project: May 2026 – present

- Worked as a Level Designer and Programmer on Willow Guard and its Frostreign DLC using Unity and C#.
- Designed and implemented one of the DLC's main story levels, including the design and implementation of gameplay puzzles. Also created and worked on additional maps using tilesets and pixel-art assets, including setting up tilemaps and preparing assets for use in the game.
- Developed an equipment rarity system, including rarity-based logic and color coding across item names, dungeon completion screens, in-game notifications, menus, and item drop visuals.
- Developed a new damage type and a corresponding arrow weapon, including a shader effect that visually and mechanically freezes targets when hit.
- Implemented an item magnetism system that allows nearby inaccessible items to be automatically attracted Implemented an item magnetism system that attracts nearby inaccessible items to the player when the player remains stationary for a moment.
- For my thesis project, Designed and implemented the DLC's achievements, including their gameplay logic in Unity and integration with Steam, while further developing and improving the game's existing achievement system.

Game Development Intern – Lohkare Games
November 2025 – December 2025

- Developed a vehicle break-in system for ***Last Drop*** using Unreal Engine and Blueprints.
- Implemented mechanics that allow players to break into vehicles using appropriate tools and steal items such as car radios, batteries, and cargo from the trunk.
- Worked with multiplayer functionality and replication, including implementing replicated door interactions and investigating replication issues together with another developer.
- Created a GitHub Issue Form Template for bug reports and wrote documentation on how to use the template and report bugs, helping the team maintain a consistent bug-reporting workflow.

Bartender – Czech-style Beer Restaurant
2008 – present
Specialized in craft and specialty beers while continuously updating my knowledge to stay aligned with industry trends. Developed patience, customer-focused thinking, and the ability to work constructively under pressure – skills highly transferable to the fast-changing IT and game development fields

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: C#, C++, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, XAML, MySQL (MariaDB)
Software & Tools: .NET, Unreal Engine, Unity, Visual Studio, VS Code, HeidiSQL, Azure DevOps, Jira, Blender, Git, GitHub, GitLab

INTERESTS

Traveling, Hiking, Planning, Games, Audiobooks, Escape Rooms

https://www.linkedin.com/in/katja-kulmala-628706377/ Github